

➤ Failed to start Vsftpd ftp daemon

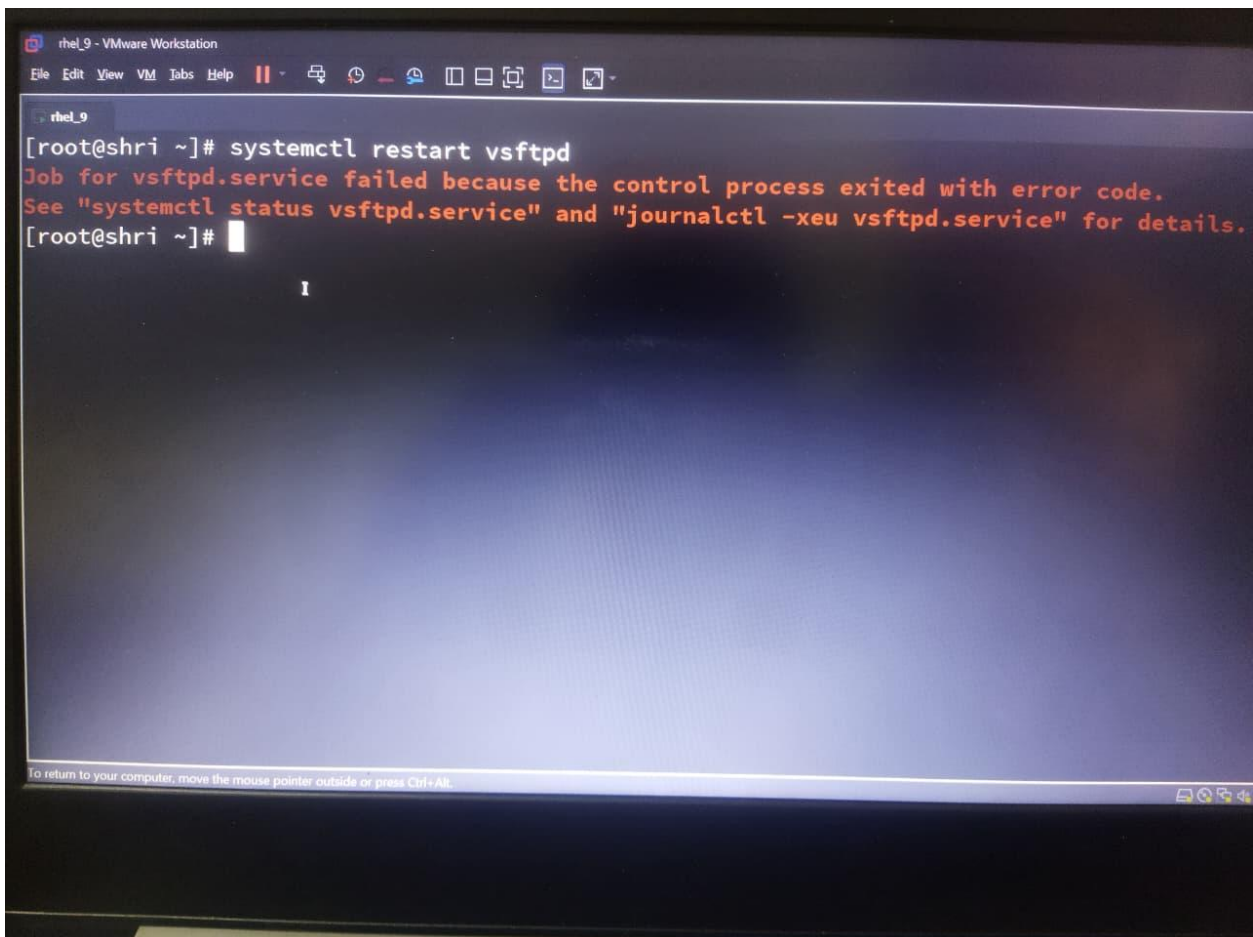
• Problem Statement

During restarting the vsftpd service in RHEL 9 error occurred

Error :

Job for vsftpd.service failed because the control process exited with error code.

See "systemctl status vsftpd.service" & "journalctl -xeu vsftpd.service" for details.



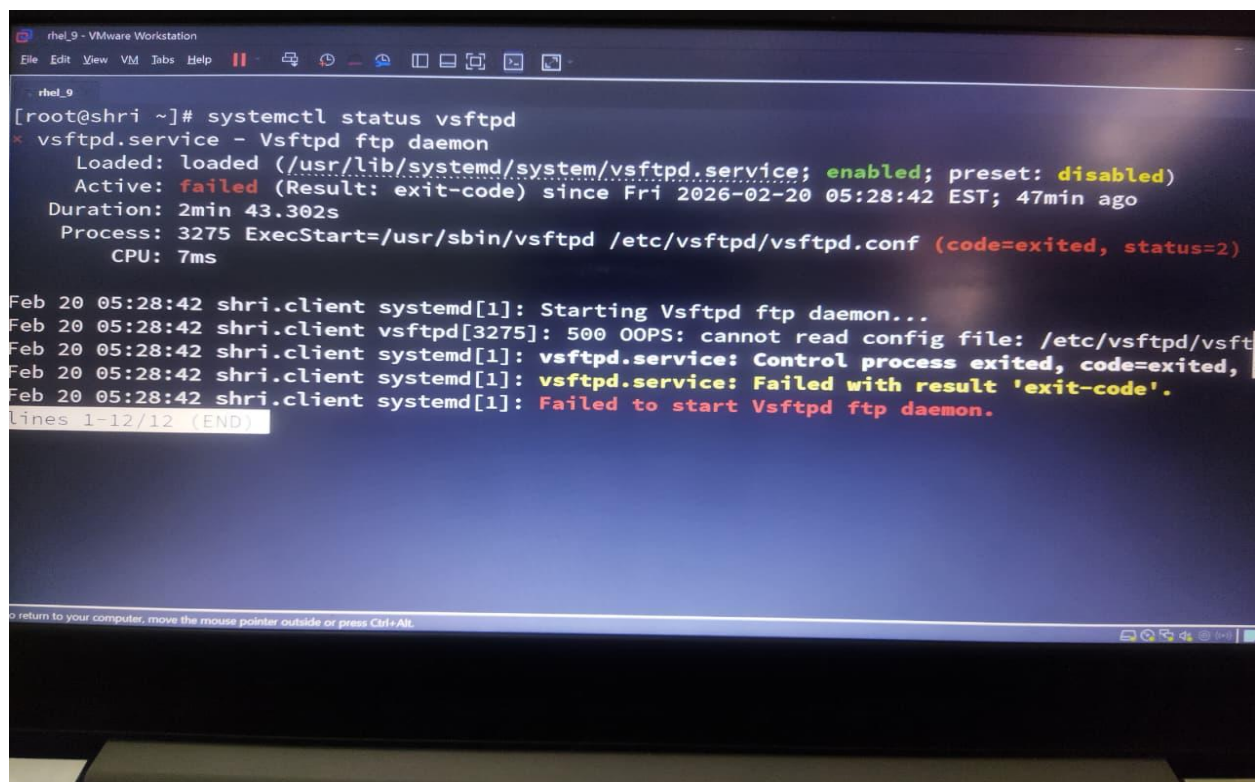
```
rhel_9 - VMware Workstation
File Edit View VM Tabs Help
[root@shri ~]# systemctl restart vsftpd
Job for vsftpd.service failed because the control process exited with error code.
See "systemctl status vsftpd.service" and "journalctl -xeu vsftpd.service" for details.
[root@shri ~]#
```

The screenshot shows a terminal window titled 'rhel_9 - VMware Workstation'. The terminal output shows the command 'systemctl restart vsftpd' being executed. The response is an error message: 'Job for vsftpd.service failed because the control process exited with error code. See "systemctl status vsftpd.service" and "journalctl -xeu vsftpd.service" for details.' The prompt '[root@shri ~]#' is visible at the bottom of the terminal.

The screenshot shows the exact error that occurs after restarting vsftpd service

DIAGNOSIS:

1. As first we checked the status of vsftpd service.



```
rhel_9 - VMware Workstation
File Edit View VM Tabs Help
rhel_9
[root@shri ~]# systemctl status vsftpd
* vsftpd.service - Vsftpd ftp daemon
   Loaded: loaded (/usr/lib/systemd/system/vsftpd.service; enabled; preset: disabled)
   Active: failed (Result: exit-code) since Fri 2026-02-20 05:28:42 EST; 47min ago
  Duration: 2min 43.302s
   Process: 3275 ExecStart=/usr/sbin/vsftpd /etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf (code=exited, status=2)
      CPU: 7ms

Feb 20 05:28:42 shri.client systemd[1]: Starting Vsftpd ftp daemon...
Feb 20 05:28:42 shri.client vsftpd[3275]: 500 OOPS: cannot read config file: /etc/vsftpd/vsft
Feb 20 05:28:42 shri.client systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Control process exited, code=exited,
Feb 20 05:28:42 shri.client systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Failed with result 'exit-code'.
Feb 20 05:28:42 shri.client systemd[1]: Failed to start Vsftpd ftp daemon.
lines 1-12/12 (END)
```

2. Then checked logs-journalctl -xe and /var/log/messages &5 vsftpd.conf

```
rhel_9 - VMware Workstation
File Edit View VM Tabs Help

rhel_9
Defined-By: systemd
Support: https://access.redhat.com/support

A start job for unit vsftpd.service has finished with a failure.

The job identifier is 2963 and the job result is failed.
Feb 20 05:28:42 shri.client systemd[1]: Starting Vsftpd ftp daemon...
Subject: A start job for unit vsftpd.service has begun execution
Defined-By: systemd
Support: https://access.redhat.com/support

A start job for unit vsftpd.service has begun execution.

The job identifier is 3069.
Feb 20 05:28:42 shri.client vsftpd[3275]: 500 OOPS: cannot read config file: /etc/vsftpd/vsft>
Feb 20 05:28:42 shri.client systemd[1]: vsftpd.service: Control process exited, code=exited, >
Subject: Unit process exited
Defined-By: systemd
Support: https://access.redhat.com/support

lines 4113-4132/4162 99%

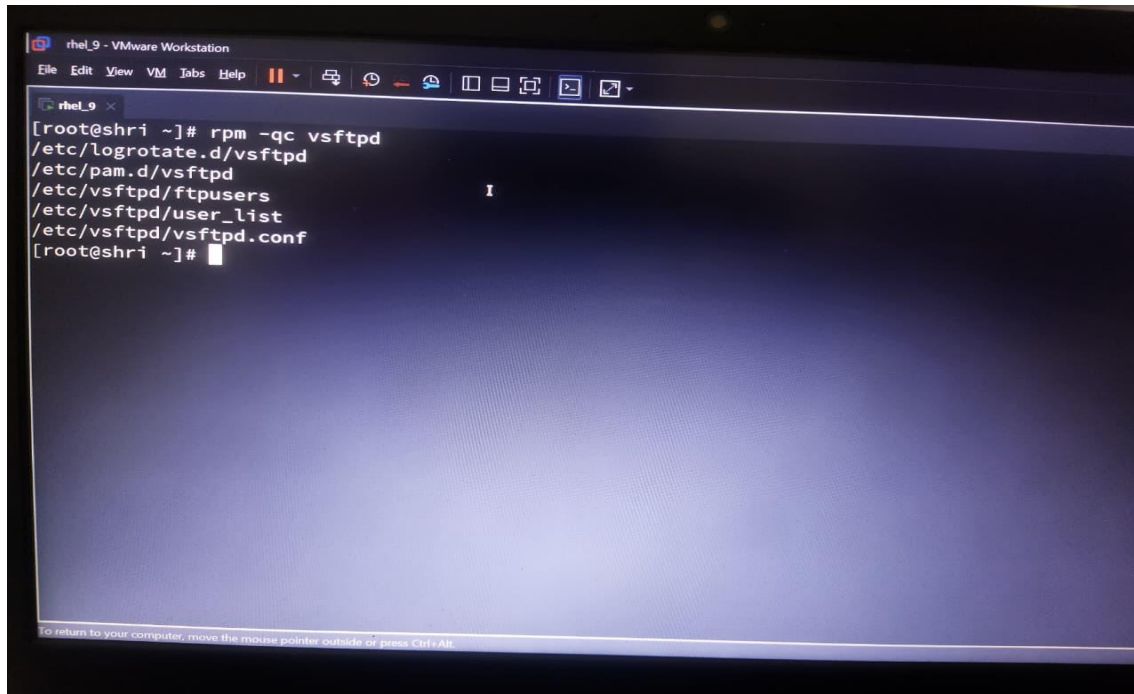
to return to your computer, move the mouse pointer outside or press Ctrl+Alt.
```

3. Got the same error in both status and logs that
Error -500 OOPS: can not read config file: /etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf
4. With help of chatgpt cross checked the error by the below command

➤ SOLUTION

1. Check the vsftpd config file :

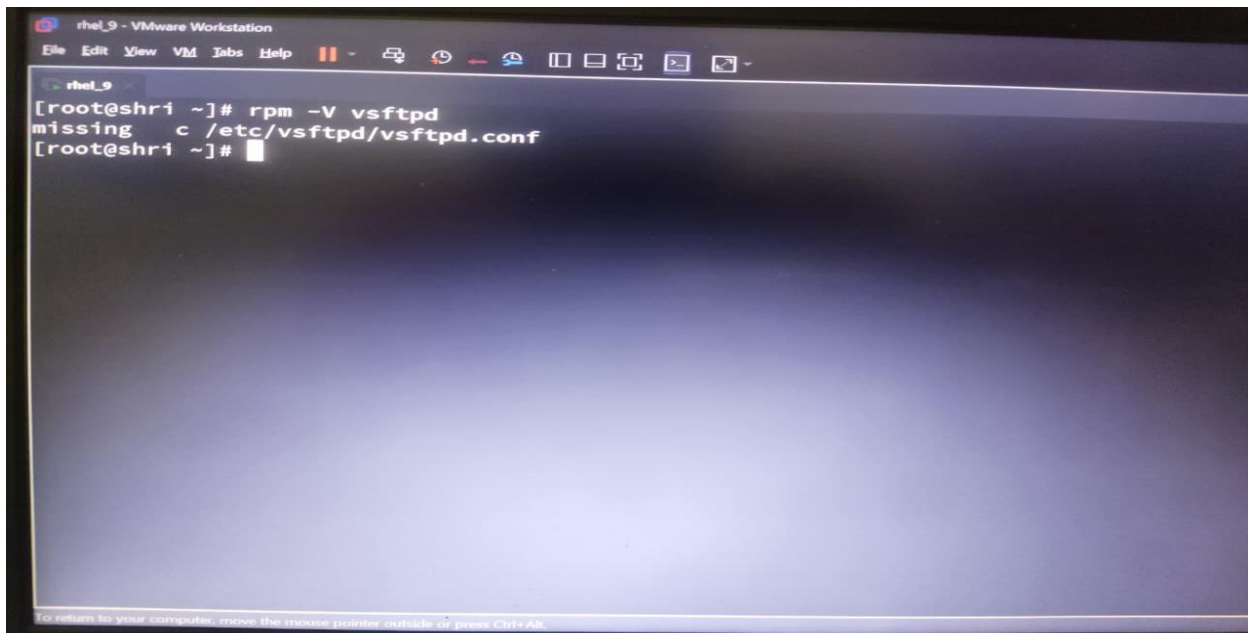
rpm -qc vsftpd



```
rhel_9 - VMware Workstation
File Edit View VM Tabs Help
rhel_9
[root@shri ~]# rpm -qc vsftpd
/etc/logrotate.d/vsftpd
/etc/pam.d/vsftpd
/etc/vsftpd/ftppusers
/etc/vsftpd/user_list
/etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf
[root@shri ~]#
```

2. Check the missing config file

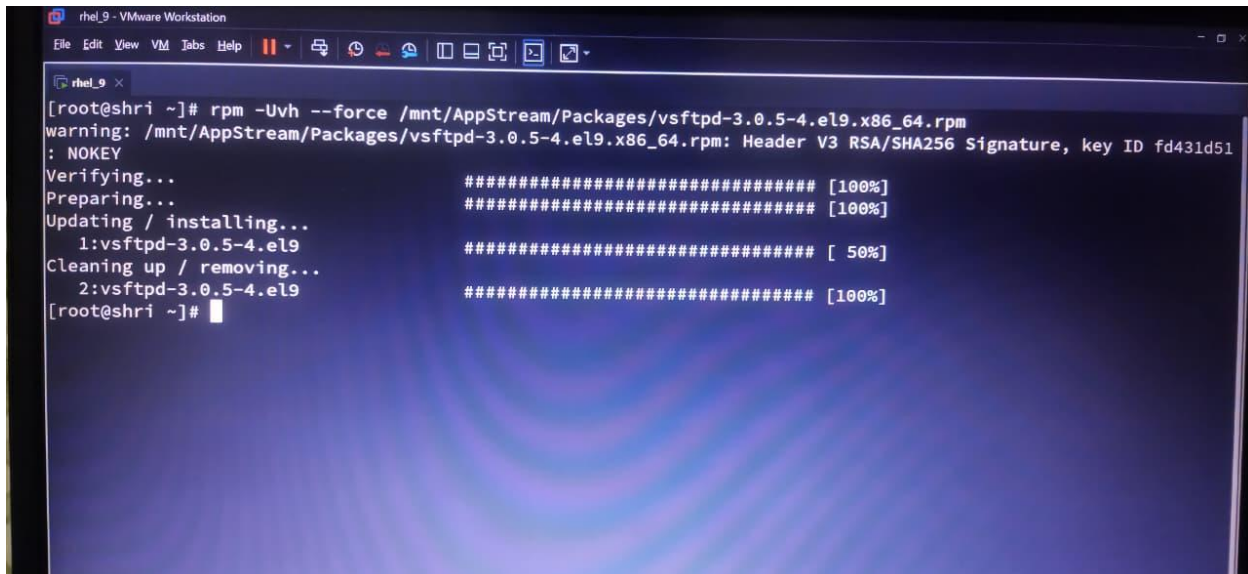
rpm -V vsftpd



```
rhel_9 - VMware Workstation
File Edit View VM Tabs Help
rhel_9
[root@shri ~]# rpm -V vsftpd
missing c /etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf
[root@shri ~]#
```

3. Installing or upgrading the vsftpd package

rpm -Uvh --force /mnt/Appstream/Packages/vsftpd-3.0.5-4.el9.x86_64.rpm



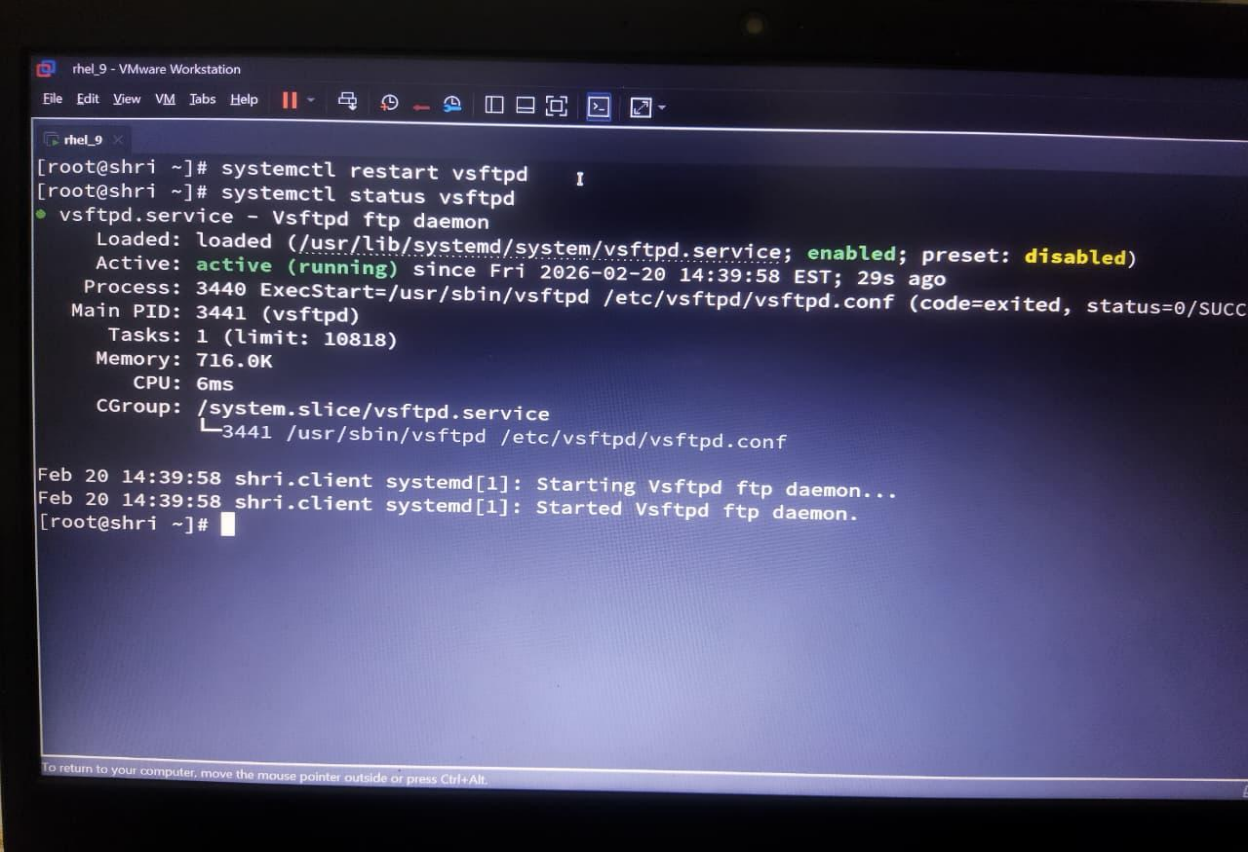
```
rhel_9 - VMware Workstation
File Edit View VM Tabs Help
[root@shri ~]# rpm -Uvh --force /mnt/AppStream/Packages/vsftpd-3.0.5-4.el9.x86_64.rpm
warning: /mnt/AppStream/Packages/vsftpd-3.0.5-4.el9.x86_64.rpm: Header V3 RSA/SHA256 Signature, key ID fd431d51
: NOKEY
Verifying... ##### [100%]
Preparing... ##### [100%]
Updating / installing...
 1:vsftpd-3.0.5-4.el9 ##### [ 50%]
Cleaning up / removing...
 2:vsftpd-3.0.5-4.el9 ##### [100%]
[root@shri ~]#
```

4 . restart the service

Systemctl restart vsftpd

5. Check the status of service

#systemctl status vsftpd



```
rhel_9 - VMware Workstation
File Edit View VM Tabs Help
rhel_9 x
[root@shri ~]# systemctl restart vsftpd
[root@shri ~]# systemctl status vsftpd
● vsftpd.service - Vsftpd ftp daemon
   Loaded: loaded (/usr/lib/systemd/system/vsftpd.service; enabled; preset: disabled)
   Active: active (running) since Fri 2026-02-20 14:39:58 EST; 29s ago
     Process: 3440 ExecStart=/usr/sbin/vsftpd /etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf (code=exited, status=0/SUCCESS)
    Main PID: 3441 (vsftpd)
      Tasks: 1 (limit: 10818)
     Memory: 716.0K
        CPU: 6ms
    CGroup: /system.slice/vsftpd.service
            └─3441 /usr/sbin/vsftpd /etc/vsftpd/vsftpd.conf

Feb 20 14:39:58 shri.client systemd[1]: Starting Vsftpd ftp daemon...
Feb 20 14:39:58 shri.client systemd[1]: Started Vsftpd ftp daemon.
[root@shri ~]#
```

To return to your computer, move the mouse pointer outside or press Ctrl+Alt.

✓ Solve the error.....